

Chapter : 11

Designing Effective Outputs

Although the technology changes rapidly, certain usage factors remain fairly constant in relation to technological breakthroughs.

① User of the output :

The type of user determines the format of the outputs. For example, managers may need summarized reports, while operators may need detailed data.

② Number of users :

If many user need the output → web based systems, or printed copies are suitable.

If only one user → screen display or audio output is enough.

If many users need different outputs at different times → Web documents or terminal-based screens are preferred.

③ Location of output:

The physical destination where the output is required should be considered. Example: remote users may need online access, while office users may use printed reports.

④ Purpose of output:

The output should support user needs and organizational tasks. For instance, outputs may be used for decision making

⑤ Speed of outputs:

The required speed depends on the management level. Higher-level managers usually need faster outputs for quick decision-making.

⑥ Frequency of access:

Frequently used outputs should be easily accessible (e.g.: Online systems). Infrequently used output can be stored in archives as CD-ROM or digital storage.

⑦ Storage duration:

The length of time output needs to be stored affects the medium used.

⑧ Regulatory & Requirements

Some outputs must follow government or organizational regulations regarding format, storage and distribution.

⑨ Cost considerations

Both initial setup costs and ongoing maintenance costs must be evaluated before choosing output technology.

⑩ Human and environmental factors:

Factors like accessibility, workspace, temperature control, lighting and user wifi must be considered to proper functioning.

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Q Explain the objective of input design & in an information system. Why is input quality important for system output?

Answer:

The quality of system input directly determines the quality of system output.

The concept is often summarized as "Garbage in, Garbage out" (GIGO), meaning that, incorrect or poorly designed input will always produce incorrect results. Therefore, proper input design is essential for an effective information system.

Objective of input design:

① Effectiveness:

Input forms and methods should serve a specific purpose for users.

They must collect only relevant data needed for the system.

② Accuracy:

The design should ensure correct data only entry. Validation rules and checks can help reduce errors during input.

③ Ease of use:

Input should be simple and easy to understand. Users should not feel confused.

Consistency: Same format should be used everywhere.

Example: Same data format in all forms.

⑤ Simplicity:

Design should be clean and not complicated. Only important fields should be shown.

⑥ Attractiveness:

The design should look nice.

A good design makes users comfortable.